6.7 Measuring, time and money: activities

← Unit overview

1. Kitchen measuring

You need: kitchen scales, a measuring jug, a simple recipe (pancakes work well).

1. Read the recipe together. Which units are used? (g, ml, dl, a spoon.)
2. He weighs and measures the ingredients. Ask before each one: "Will 250 g of flour look like a lot or a little?"
3. Convert as you go: "The recipe says 0,5 l of milk. How many ml is that? Where's that on the jug?"
4. Eat the pancakes. (This is essential.)

Talk about it: "Which was heavier, the flour or the milk? Did you guess right?"

2. Measure the house

You need: a tape measure, squared paper, a pencil.

1. Measure his bedroom: length and width in metres (round to whole or half metres).
2. Draw it on squared paper: 1 square = 1 m (or ½ m).
3. **Perimeter:** "If we put a ribbon all the way round the edge of the floor, how long would it be?"
4. **Area:** "How many 1 m × 1 m squares fit on the floor?" Count them on the drawing.
5. Compare with another room. Which room has the bigger area? The bigger perimeter? Are they the same room?

Talk about it: "Can a room have a bigger perimeter but a smaller area than another room?"

3. Dutch clock talk

You need: an analogue clock (or a paper plate clock with a split-pin), a phone showing a digital clock.

1. Set times on the analogue clock. He says them in Dutch (*kwart over drie*, *tien voor half vijf*) and writes the digital time.
2. Swap: you say a digital time in the 24-hour clock (16:20); he sets the analogue clock and says it in Dutch.
3. Include morning and evening: "Is 19:50 in the morning or the evening? What would you say in Dutch?"

Talk about it: "Why do you think Dutch says *half vier* for 3:30?"

4. Train trip planner

You need: the NS app or a printed train timetable.

Plan a real or pretend day trip. When does the train leave? When does it arrive? How long is the journey? If there's a change of train, how long is the wait? What time do you need to leave home if cycling to the station takes 12 minutes?

Talk about it: "Which is quicker, the direct train or the one with a change? How did you work it out?"

5. Shop with change

You need: coins and notes (real or play), price labels with cents.

He is the shopkeeper. You buy two or three items (€1,29, €2,15, €3,49), pay with a €10 note, and he gives change by counting up. Swap roles and make a deliberate mistake for him to catch.

Bonus: explain the Dutch 5-cent rounding when paying cash. "€6,93 is rounded to €6,95 if you pay with coins."

Talk about it: "Why do shops count up to give change instead of subtracting?"

6. Family calendar

You need: a wall calendar or a printed year calendar.

- How many days until his birthday? Until the next school holiday?
- Which months have 31 days? (The knuckle trick: make two fists; knuckles are 31-day months, the dips between them are shorter months.)
- "What day of the week will it be in 10 days? In 3 weeks?"
- "Is 2028 a leap year (*schrikkeljaar*)? How do you know?" (Yes, it can be divided by 4.)

Talk about it: "Why do you think February is shorter?"

Conversation prompts (any time)

- "About how tall is that tree? How did you estimate?"
- "Which weighs more: a kilo of feathers or a kilo of bricks?"
- "How long do you think it takes to cycle to school? Let's check tomorrow."
- "What time will it be in 45 minutes? How did you work that out?"